Bow Valley College

Course Outline

NURS9302

Foundational Pharmacology: Ensuring Patient Safety in Medication Administration

Winter 2024 - Spring 2025

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NURS9302 Foundational Pharmacology: Ensuring Patient Safety in Medication Administration

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This pharmacology course builds on the foundational knowledge of anatomy and physiology, pathology, and microbiology to teach students the safe and effective administration of medications to patients. Students will gain a comprehensive understanding of drug classifications, mechanisms of action, pharmacokinetics, and pharmacodynamics. They will also learn about the various routes of drug administration including oral, topical, intravenous, and intramuscular, and how to choose the appropriate route for a particular patient and medication. Additionally, the course will cover important topics such as drug interactions, adverse reactions, and contraindications. Students will also learn about the legal and ethical considerations surrounding medication administration including documentation, informed concern, and patient confidentiality. By the end of the course, students will have a solid understanding of Canadian medications and be well-equipped to provide safe and competent medication administration to patients.

REQUISITES	None
EQUIVALENTS	None
CREDITS	0
HOURS	45
ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR	No
ZERO TEXTBOOK COST	

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong learners. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that learners acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

College-Wide Outcomes:

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy

6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning
8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

#	COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED
1	Students will develop a comprehensive understanding of various drug classifications, their mechanisms of action, and how these drugs interact with the human body, including pharmacokinetics and pharmacodynamics	1,2,3,7.8
2	Students will gain a comprehensive understanding in different routes, including oral, topical, intravenous, and intramuscular, and will be able to select the most appropriate route for specific patients and medications.	2,3,7,8,9
3	Students will be able to identify and manage major drug interactions, adverse reactions, and contraindications, ensuring safe medication administration and minimizing potential risks to patients.	1,2,4,7,8
4	Students will understand the legal and ethical considerations associated with medication administration, including documentation, informed consent, and patient confidentiality, in compliance with Canadian healthcare regulations	1,2,4,7,8
5	By the end of the course, students will be equipped with the knowledge and skills required to provide safe and competent medication administration to patients in a Canadian healthcare setting, demonstrating proficiency in the field of pharmacology.	1,2,3,4,5,7

COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

WEEK/HOURS	MODULES
	Foundational Pharmacology: The Basics
	Foundational Pharmacology: Respiratory
	Foundational Pharmacology: Analgesics & Musculoskeletal
	Foundational Pharmacology: Central Nervous System
	Foundational Pharmacology: Endocrine
	Foundational Pharmacology: Gastrointestinal
	Foundational Pharmacology: Autonomic Nervous System;
	Foundational Pharmacology: Cardiac & Renal
	Foundational Pharmacology: Anti-infectives.

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A grade of P is required to pass this course. Learners may be required to pass this course in order to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

All assignments must be submitted to achieve course completion.

Please consult with the program area or the Bow Valley College website for further details.

GRADING SCHEME

Symbol	**Description**	**Grade Point Value**
P	Pass	N/A
F	Fail	N/A
BD	Basic/Developing (Foundational programming courses only)	N/A
CM	Complete	N/A
NCM	Not Complete	N/A

REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

Canadian Nurses Association. (2017). *Code of ethics for registered nurses.* *https://hl-prod-ca-oc-download.s3-ca-central-1.amazonaws.com/CNA/2f975e7e-4a40-45ca-863c-5ebf0a138d5e/UploadedImages/documents/Code_of_Ethics_2017_Edition_Secure_Interactive.pdf*

College of Registered Nurses of Alberta. (2019). *Entry-level competencies for the practice of registered nurses*. https://nurses.ab.ca/media/5ndpyfar/entry-level-competencies-for-the-practice-of-registered-nurses-mar-2019.pdf

College of Registered Nurses of Alberta. (2022). *Documentation standards*. https://www.nurses.ab.ca/media/xx3dycmf/documentation-standards-2022.pdf

College of Registered Nurses of Alberta. (2021, March). Medication Management Standards. https://nurses.ab.ca/media/3lfhdrrq/medication-management-standards-mar-2021.pdf

College of Registered Nurses of Alberta. (2018, December). Guidelines for Medications and Vaccine Injection Safety. https://nurses.ab.ca/media/3lfhdrrq/medication-management-standards-mar-2021.pdf

Ernstmeyer, K. and Christman, E. (Eds.). (2020). *Nursing Pharmacology* by *Chippewa Valley Technical College* licensed under CC BY 4.0.

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Learners with a disability (learning, physical, and/or mental health) may qualify for academic and exam accommodations. For more information, or to apply for accommodations, learners should make an appointment with Accessibility Services in the Learner Success Services (LSS) Department. Accessibility Services can also assist learners who may be struggling with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. To make an appointment visit LSS on the first floor of the south campus or call 403-410-1440. It is the learner's responsibility to contact Accessibility Services and request academic accommodations. For more information, please visit our website at http://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/accessibility.

INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Learners are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Integrity (500-1-7), Learner Code of Conduct, Procedures and Guidelines (500-1-1), Learner Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1-10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13). Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by learners is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan. Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

Turnitin:

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student papers. Students acknowledge that any course work or essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

Online Exam Proctoring:

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, bowvalleycollege.ca.

Learners are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

Collection of Personal Information:

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course section. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements.

You may use the recordings only for educational purposes and you must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission.

Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 33(c) of the Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (Alberta) to deliver academic programming, support learner flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course activities and outcomes. If you have any questions about the collection, disclosure, use, or protection of this information, please contact the College's Access and Privacy Officer at foip@bowvalleycollege.ca.